

Resource: Campus Ministry

Connect. Encounter. Live.

Campus Ministry celebrates the diversity of faith traditions represented in our university community by meeting the pastoral and spiritual growth needs of all. [Our Campus Ministry office](https://www.stthomas.edu/ministry/about/index.html)  (<https://www.stthomas.edu/ministry/about/index.html>) provides a supportive environment for students seeking to grow in faith and understanding of God, and we work to deepen our community's commitment to form the whole person by offering students the opportunity to build a strong community where all are welcome, loved and supported.

Our [Staff](https://www.stthomas.edu/ministry/about/staff/index.html)  (<https://www.stthomas.edu/ministry/about/staff/index.html>):

Fr. Christopher Collins, SJ – VP for Mission and Director of Campus Ministry

Donna Matuszewski – Office Manager

Christina Crow - Sacramental Coordinator – Weddings and OCIA

Jacob Benda, Director of Music and Liturgy

Sarah Chamseddine, Program Manager -Including Interfaith and Ecumenical programs

Marta Pereira – Director of Cultural Initiatives and Spiritual Formation

Fr. Thomas Saucier, OP – Campus Ministry Chaplain

Tamim Saidi – Muslim Faith Leader

Abby Schmulewitz – Jewish Faith Leader

Campus Ministry student leaders:

Hospitality Leaders - Welcoming students to our space

Peer Ministers – Creating meaningful encounters

Retreat Team leaders- Inviting students to make a space for God in their lives

Multicultural programs leaders- Providing spaces and opportunities where cultural expressions of faith and traditions are cherished

Liturgical Assistants: Contributing to the beauty of our daily and weekend liturgies

We offer you a space to **CONNECT** with other peers as you grow in your faith during your St. Thomas journey, **ENCOUNTER** God more deeply and to **LIVE** your faith more intentionally!

CONNECT

We welcome all students to our annual **Block Party**, traditionally celebrated on the first Thursday of classes. This is a great opportunity to meet our Campus Ministry team, connect with faith organizations on campus and experience St Thomas' vibrant faith community. If you are not as familiar with Campus Ministry and other opportunities on campus, the Block Party is a great front-door to learn more. We are also grateful for your support in inviting residents to take part in this big event.

As each academic year begins, encourage First Year Students to **Invite God In** by participating in our **First Year Retreat**. Held on the last weekend of September, this retreat offers them the opportunity to get away, connect with students interested in faith connections and get their St Thomas faith journey off to a great start. Students are able to **EXPERIENCE** [👉\(https://www.youtube.com/shorts/-dCTz00gSvw\)](https://www.youtube.com/shorts/-dCTz00gSvw) the beauty of nature, walk the camp trails, canoe, reflect by the lake, play volleyball, and enjoy the company of peers by the bonfire – all while making lasting connections with other first year students.

Peer Ministry

Having themselves experienced the gift of encountering Christ, **Peer Ministers** [👉\(https://www.stthomas.edu/ministry/programming/peer-ministry/index.html\)](https://www.stthomas.edu/ministry/programming/peer-ministry/index.html) are committed to helping other students to deepen their relationship with God and to live out the Gospel call to love and serve our neighbors, by *creating meaningful encounters*. Peer Ministers are a great resource to get connected with the faith community on campus and create intentional community. The best place to meet the Peer Ministers and get to know about their programs and upcoming events is by attending **Pancakes with Jesus** on the second Wednesday of each month in Scooters. Be sure to introduce yourselves to the team, let them know that you are an RA, and know that they are excited to work alongside and support you as fellow student leaders.

ENCOUNTER

Campus Ministry offers students great possibilities to deepen their relationship with God through countless opportunities in a weekly or monthly basis. Here are some opportunities to explore:

Sacramental Life

The Chapel of St. Thomas Aquinas stands at the center of the campus as a beacon of faith reminding us of God's presence among us. We invite everybody to participate in our **[daily and Sunday](#)**

liturgies ➞ <https://www.stthomas.edu/ministry/catholic-liturgy/index.html>) and make the Lord's Day a grounding experience for students' time at St. Thomas. The Chapel and **other spaces of prayer**, ➞ <https://www.stthomas.edu/ministry/sacred-spaces/index.html>) offers a beautiful environment for prayer and silence amidst the busy college life.

Tommie Catholic

Join this lively community of students who authentically embrace their Catholic faith and make Jesus the center of their lives. Events are planned by students for students. Find us in the Iversen Center for Faith every Tuesday from 8-9pm.

Come and be embraced by the community, enjoy the variety of topics, and get plugged into everything Catholic on campus.

Tommie BeLoved

Each Sunday evening, Christian students gather in the OEC Auditorium for a time of praise and worship. Together they unite their hearts, share the love of Jesus, and build a community where everyone feels seen and valued.

FE y Amigos

We at Campus Ministry offer Hispanic students, and all interested in Hispanic experience of faith, the opportunity to build community by celebrating and enriching the faith experience and traditions.

Celebrando la Fe juntos ➞ <https://www.stthomas.edu/ministry/programming/hispanic-students/index.html>) – caFE y Amigos are monthly gatherings with food and fellowship. This event is brought to students by a collaboration between Campus Ministry and Catholic Studies Guadalupe Scholars with the aim to offer students the opportunity to gather and celebrate their faith together. Although this initiative is tailored to Hispanic students, everyone is welcome!

Afro Christian Fellowship

The monthly ACF nights offer students a space to celebrate their faith through cultural traditions. Students can join this time of fellowship and growth, as we learn about African faith tradition and expression. Although tailored for students of African descent, everyone is welcome!

Retreats

Campus Ministry offers a number of overnight and weekend retreats throughout the academic year. From on-campus half-day events to destination weekend-long retreats, students have the opportunity to get away from the hecticness of daily life to experience a time devoted to the encounter with God and one another. Learn more about the **retreat offerings** ➞ <https://www.stthomas.edu/ministry/programming/retreats/index.html>) throughout the year.

Multifaith initiatives

Campus Ministry is committed to supporting students of all faith traditions. These are some of the opportunities offered to students:

Muslim student programming

Campus Ministry supports our Muslim community by offering opportunities to enrich their faith throughout the week. Our Imam leads a halaqa (scripture study) each Wednesday and offers Salat-ul-Jum'a (Friday prayer) every Friday, followed by a community meal. Both opportunities take place in the meditation room in the [Iversen Center for Faith](https://www.stthomas.edu/about/our-campuses/st-paul/iversen-center-for-faith/index.html). [↗\(https://www.stthomas.edu/about/our-campuses/st-paul/iversen-center-for-faith/index.html\)](https://www.stthomas.edu/about/our-campuses/st-paul/iversen-center-for-faith/index.html) The meditation room and wudu stations in the Iversen Center for Faith, as well as the three other meditation spaces on campus are available for use at any time.

During Ramadan, Campus Ministry helps to coordinate several opportunities on campus, including iftar dinners and an Eid celebration.

Peace Meals

This biweekly event gathers people from different faith traditions, religious identities, and cultural backgrounds to share a meal and have honest discussions, with the goal of building greater awareness and understanding of each other's worldviews.

Peace Meals offers a path forward to build community and understanding across lines of religious and cultural division by gathering at the common table for food, friendship, and hospitality.

Peace Meals is a six-part series that requires advance registration, so be sure to sign up at the beginning of the semester.

St. Thomas Hillel

Jewish students, and others who would like to learn about Jewish traditions, are invited to gather weekly on Thursdays in Campus Ministry. At the gatherings students celebrate holidays, play games, eat Jewish snacks, and build community. All are welcome!

Faith organizations on campus

Campus Ministry places an emphasis on the call, "to promote the pastoral care of all members of the university community" (EE 6,1)

The work on Campus Ministry is complemented by the role of [faith-based clubs and affiliated ministrie](https://tommielink.stthomas.edu/organizations?categories=8504) [↗\(https://tommielink.stthomas.edu/organizations?categories=8504\)](https://tommielink.stthomas.edu/organizations?categories=8504)s that aligns with the institution's mission and value cooperation in the pastoral care of students.

Check out Tommie Link to learn about the events and activities hosted by each of the six faith-based student clubs that are affiliated with local Christian ministries.

Explore [Campus Ministry](https://www.stthomas.edu/ministry/)  (<https://www.stthomas.edu/ministry/>) to discover more initiatives that will help you and your residents encounter God. We are grateful for the connection you can support between Campus Ministry and your residents.

LIVE

Campus Ministry offers students connections and opportunities for encounters so that they can live with meaning and purpose and embrace their faith more intentionally. We offer students the resources and accompaniment to:

- Tackle the big questions of purpose and meaning
- Take part in our weekday and Sunday liturgies
- Participate in our regular programming
- Share their gifts and passions by becoming part of our team or volunteering in our different initiatives
- Connect with our spiritual leaders and staff to support your faith journey

As a Catholic university we are committed to support all students' spiritual life and flourishing. We do this by being a companion in your journey as you explore deep questions of meaning and purpose.

Our mission is to invite and encourage all students to encounter God's presence in the world and to provide the connection to a vibrant faith community through the presence of a passionate staff team and student ministry leaders.

Encourage your residents to visit us at the [Iversen Center for Faith](https://www.stthomas.edu/about/our-campuses/st-paul/iversen-center-for-faith/index.html)  (<https://www.stthomas.edu/about/our-campuses/st-paul/iversen-center-for-faith/index.html>) and learn more about our programs by following us on Instagram, [@ust_campusministry](https://www.instagram.com/ust_campusministry)  (https://www.instagram.com/ust_campusministry), and [Tommie Link](https://tommielink.stthomas.edu/organization/campusministry)  (<https://tommielink.stthomas.edu/organization/campusministry>).



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